

Field Overview: Disciplinary Structure and Growth Dynamics

The Active Inference literature has undergone a profound phase transition. What originated in the late 2000s as a densely clustered niche within theoretical neuroscience has explosively expanded into a multi-disciplinary research program spanning three primary domains and eight strictly tracked categories. Our corpus, extracted from arXiv, Semantic Scholar, and OpenAlex and rigorously deduplicated to $N = 785$ papers (1977–2026), captures the breadth, tempo, and internal architecture of this expansion.

